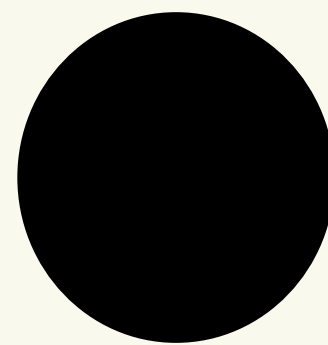


No one saw him disembark in the
unanimous **night**,



no one saw the bamboo canoe sink into the sacred mud,
but in a few days there was no one who did not know that the taciturn
man came from the South and that his home had been one of those
numberless villages upstream in the deeply cleft side of the mountain,
where the Zend language has not been contaminated by Greek and
where leprosy is infrequent.

What is certain is that the *grey* man kissed the mud, climbed up the
bank with pushing aside (probably, without feeling) the blades which
were lacerating his flesh, and crawled, nauseated and bloodstained, up
to the circular enclosure crowned with a stone tiger or horse, which
sometimes was the color of *flame* and now was that of **ashes**.